away. Could it be the beginning of the end? Thirty-eight Israeli soldiers have been killed since the beginning of the ground offensive in Gaza. The scenes from Al-Shifa Hospital and its surroundings are heartrending. The Palestinian civilians' plight is awful. Israel is convinced that Hamas tactically established its headquarters in tunnels under the hospital compound, and that Yahya Sinwar, the Hamas chief, is holed up there. Time will tell, but in the meantime civilians are getting killed.

The negotiations in Qatar about the exchange of hostages for Hamas prisoners in Israel go on, but the information about agreements is contradictory.

In a poll of the Israel Democracy Institute, 70 percent of Israeli Arabs feel close to the country in the present time of war; in June, the identification was only 40 percent. Strange but encouraging. On the other hand, a poll taken in mid-October by the Peace Index of Tel Aviv University showed a sharp increase of hawkish opinion among Israeli Jews. Whereas in September more than 40 percent of respondents were in favor of negotiations with the Palestine Authority for some peace agreement, the proportion fell to 24 percent in October. This was to be expected.

Each time I see or hear reference made to the Holocaust in regard to the ongoing war, I cringe. When pro-Palestinian demonstrators use the term, I mostly get upset by their stupidity and total ignorance of what they are talking about; when our people use the Holocaust as a comparison to what this or that person said or did, I feel shame and disgust at such wanton use of Nazi criminality to vilify our present detractors. The immediate example that comes to mind is the use by our ambassador to the UN of the yellow star of Nazi times to denounce the supposed antisemitism of the secretary-general of the organization. How silly and shameful!

Saturday, November 11